

# HUMANITIES/LIBERAL STUDIES

## What can I do with this major?

| AREAS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | EMPLOYERS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | STRATEGIES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| <b>EDUCATION</b><br>Higher Education:<br>Teaching<br>Research<br>Administration<br>Admissions<br>Financial aid<br>Academic advising and support services<br>Development<br>Alumni affairs<br>International education and study abroad<br>Student life (e.g., residence life, student activities, new student orientation, leadership, greek life, multicultural affairs)<br>Information/Library science<br>Primary and secondary education:<br>Teaching<br>Administration<br>Library sciences<br>Community education:<br>Literacy<br>English as a second language (ESL)<br>GED preparation<br>Tutoring | Universities and colleges<br>Academic support programs (e.g., Educational Advancement Program, Upward Bound)<br>School and community libraries<br>K-12 schools (public and private)<br>Head Start programs<br>Private learning centers<br>Test preparation organizations<br>Adult education programs (e.g., those focusing on GED preparation)<br>Nonprofit organizations including those promoting literacy (e.g., VISTA)<br>Language institutes, local and abroad<br>Museums | Earn a Ph.D. to teach and research at four-year institutions. Some two-year institutions may accept a master's degree. The interdisciplinary nature of liberal arts and humanities is good preparation for advanced education in a variety of fields.<br>Obtain a master's degree in student affairs, higher education administration, or library/ information science to prepare for those fields.<br>If interested in K-12 teaching, fulfill requirements for certification. This may involve a double major or a minor. Research alternative paths to certification such as Teach for America and other similar programs.<br>Get involved in leadership roles on campus including peer mentor, resident advisor, orientation leader, or tutor.<br>Volunteer with community organizations.<br>Join related professional associations as a student member.<br>Develop strong communication, public speaking, and foreign language skills. Build cultural competence.<br>Secure strong recommendations from faculty, and maintain a high grade point average. Assist a professor with research or take an independent study class to develop research skills. |

| AREAS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | EMPLOYERS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | STRATEGIES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| <b><u>ADVOCACY</u></b><br>Domestic and international advocacy<br>Humanitarian services<br>Development:<br>Economic<br>Community<br>Housing<br>Disaster/Disease relief<br>HIV/AIDS advocacy<br>Policy development<br>Program administration<br>Education<br>Volunteer coordination<br>Grant writing<br>Fundraising/development<br>Research | Community action agencies<br>Nonprofit organizations<br>Private voluntary organizations<br>Faith-based organizations (FBO's)<br>International aid and relief organizations<br>Non-governmental organizations (NGO's), e.g.,<br>International Red Cross<br>Federal government agencies with an international<br>focus (e.g., Peace Corps, USAID) or community<br>assistance focus (e.g., Americorps)<br>State and local government agencies<br>Research organizations                                                                                                                      | Gain experience through extensive volunteering or<br>by completing an internship.<br>Participate in an international service learning expe-<br>rience or church-led mission trip.<br>Get involved with cultural events or organizations<br>on campus.<br>Take additional courses in social work, global stud-<br>ies, or other relevant areas.<br>Develop excellent research, writing, communication,<br>and organizational skills. Learn how to motivate<br>individuals and groups.<br>Research organizations' values to find a good fit<br>with yours. It is critical that you are knowledge-<br>able about and committed to the work you're<br>going to do. |
| <b><u>SOCIAL SERVICES</u></b><br>Counseling<br>Psychotherapy<br>Mental health services<br>Case management<br>Programming<br>Community relations<br>Fundraising/Development<br>Administration                                                                                                                                              | Mental health institutions<br>Hospitals and clinics<br>Residential treatment facilities<br>Private and group practice<br>Correctional institutions<br>Federal, state, or local government (e.g., Depart-<br>ment of Human Services, Housing and Urban<br>Development)<br>Organizations that aid immigrants, migrant workers,<br>and refugees or focus on cultural issues<br>Youth organizations and camps (e.g., the YMCA,<br>Boys and Girls Clubs)<br>Nonprofit and social services organizations (e.g.,<br>United Way, Goodwill Industries, Salvation<br>Army)<br>Church-based programs | Supplement curriculum with courses in psychology,<br>social work, or child and family studies.<br>Obtain a graduate degree in psychology, counsel-<br>ing, or social work for increased counseling<br>opportunities or advancement into administra-<br>tive work.<br>Gain essential practical experience through part-<br>time or summer jobs and internships.<br>Volunteer with organizations that assist people of<br>diverse backgrounds.<br>Participate in training opportunities (e.g., suicide<br>prevention or crisis hotline response).<br>Acquire knowledge of government and community<br>resources available for those in need.                     |

| AREAS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | EMPLOYERS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | STRATEGIES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
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| <b><u>MEDIA AND ARTS</u></b><br>Journalism<br>Creative writing<br>Freelance writing<br>Copy writing<br>Editing<br>Research and analysis<br>Broadcasting:<br>Television<br>Radio<br>Media sales<br>Museum work<br>Arts programming<br>Art sales<br>Fundraising/Development | Newspapers<br>Magazines<br>Broadcast media companies including television<br>and movie industry<br>Radio stations<br>Foreign news agencies<br>Trade, professional, or consumer publications<br>Internet marketing sites<br>Advertising agencies<br>Publishing houses<br>Large corporations<br>Museums<br>Galleries<br>Organizations and centers devoted to the promotion<br>of the arts<br>Smithsonian Institution<br>Self-employed, freelance | Study a second field such as journalism, English, or<br>broadcasting to prepare for a career in media.<br>For positions in the arts, consider a minor in art his-<br>tory. Plan to pursue a relevant graduate degree<br>such as museum studies.<br>Write for campus publications such as college<br>newspapers, magazines, or department/pro-<br>gram newsletters. Work at campus radio or<br>television stations.<br>Use your interests and communication skills to write<br>about topics of interest for specific publications<br>(e.g., local sport magazines).<br>Intern with a publishing house, magazine, radio or<br>television station depending upon area of inter-<br>est.<br>Create a portfolio of writing samples, especially<br>those that have been published. For other<br>areas, create a website or digital portfolio to<br>promote skills to potential employers.<br>Seek opportunities for recognition and networking<br>through writing contests and freelance writing<br>submissions.<br>Become familiar with the proposal and submission<br>process involved in freelance writing. |

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**LAW AND GOVERNMENT**

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| Law (e.g., corporate practice, public interest law,<br>civil/human rights law)<br>Lobbying<br>Government relations<br>Elected or appointed leadership<br>Public policy<br>Research<br>Intelligence<br>Campaign management<br>Special interest advocacy<br>Program administration | Law firms<br>Corporate legal departments<br>Public defenders offices<br>District attorneys<br>Public interest groups<br>Civil rights organizations<br>Legal aid<br>Sole practitioner<br>Government agencies<br>Lobbying groups | Obtain the J.D. for law positions or an advanced<br>degree in public administration, public policy, or<br>international relations for government positions.<br>Supplement curriculum with relevant courses to<br>prepare for law school.<br>Participate in activities that develop strong debate<br>and public speaking skills such as mock trial.<br>Get involved with the pre-law society on campus.<br>Gain relevant experience through jobs or intern-<br>ships with law firms, government agencies, or<br>mediation centers. |
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## AREAS

## EMPLOYERS

## STRATEGIES

### LAW AND GOVERNMENT CONTINUED

Maintain a high grade point average and secure strong faculty recommendations.  
Prepare for and take the Law School Admission Test (LSAT).  
Apply for federal government internship programs while in school.  
The Foreign Service requires passage of the Foreign Service Exam, after obtaining a master's degree or significant work experience.

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### BUSINESS

Financial services and banking  
Management  
Customer service  
Sales and marketing  
Advertising and public relations  
Human resources  
Training and development  
Equity and diversity functions  
International business  
Importing/Exporting  
Travel and tourism  
Consulting

Banks and financial institutions  
Insurance companies  
Retail stores  
Hotels and restaurants  
Consumer goods manufacturers  
Multinational businesses  
Staffing agencies  
Consulting firms  
Market research firms  
Public relations agencies  
Travel agencies and tour operators  
Convention and visitors' bureaus

Double major or minor in business.  
Gain business experience through internships or part-time and summer jobs.  
Join campus organizations or professional societies and seek leadership roles.  
Understand the skills employers' desire and be prepared to demonstrate them, such as communication (oral and written), technology, interpersonal, leadership, and teamwork.  
Conduct informational interviews with professionals to learn more about career fields.  
Earn an MBA or a graduate degree in another area of interest for more advanced opportunities.  
When job searching, seek employers interested in hiring "any major."  
For international assignments, plan to start in U.S. based positions and gain experience with the company/industry. Usually more seasoned employees are given international assignments.

**AREAS****EMPLOYERS****STRATEGIES****GENERAL INFORMATION**

- Liberal studies and humanities provide an interdisciplinary background that helps students develop analytical, critical thinking, and writing skills while gaining knowledge about American and foreign cultures and histories.
- When paired with a major in another field, humanities can enhance the employability of a student because of a deeper understanding of cultural and historical backgrounds and analytical thinking, writing, and communication skills.
- Because liberal studies and humanities are broad-based, interdisciplinary majors, it is important to develop skills relevant to targeted fields through internships, part-time or summer jobs, or volunteer experiences.
- These majors are excellent candidates for a number of graduate school options because of their broad liberal arts background as well as specific interests that may set them apart from other students. For those wishing to pursue graduate education, maintain a high GPA, establish relationships with faculty to secure strong recommendations, and gain experience through volunteer, work, or research opportunities.